

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes

Wednesday, September 24, 2025

5:30 p.m. via Zoom

Administrative Service Center

415 Tumwater Blvd SW

Tumwater, WA 98501

Toni Gwin, *President, Pacific County*

Brian Mittge, *President Elect, Lewis County*

Hal Blanton, *At-Large, Lewis County*

Mary Beth Harrington, *Thurston County*

Dustin Loup, *Grays Harbor County*

Vacant Position, *Mason County*

Vacant Position, *At-Large, Thurston County*

Present Board: Toni Gwin, Brian Mittge, Mary Beth Harrington, Dustin Loup

Absent Board: Hal Blanton

Present Staff: Cheryl Heywood, Andrea Heisel, Brenda Lane, Rose Enos-Weedmark; recorder

Remote Access: Zoom: <https://Trl-org.zoom.us/j/82997086092> • Meeting ID: 829 9708 6092 • Phone Access (253) 215-8782 • Approximate Attendance = 18

Timberland Regional Library (TRL) Business Meeting Minutes

1. CALL TO ORDER AND ROLL CALL – Toni Gwin called the meeting to order at 5:30 p.m.

2. PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE – Mary Beth Harrington led the pledge

3. CORRESPONDENCE – **at 4:27 of the recording** Cheryl shares an email from a Bill Pfender on September 22nd regarding the vacant Mason County trustee position and how to submit an application.

4. PUBLIC COMMENTS – None.

5. APPROVAL OF AGENDA AND CONSENT AGENDA ITEMS – **at 5:30 of the recording**

25-028 – MARY BETH HARRINGTON MADE A MOTION TO APPROVE THE AGENDA AND CONSENT AGENDA AS PRESENTED. DUSTIN LOUP SECONDED. MOTION APPROVED (Unanimous 4).

6. EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR HIGHLIGHTS – **at 6:43 of the recording** Cheryl shares

- Staff Fest was on September 12th and was an enjoyable day for staff to get together as they have not gotten together since 2019
- The Summer Library Programs have increased the number of programs and attendance
- September is library card sign-up month; Cheryl shares her work with local tribes to sign up all employees and tribal members with a library card
- October is Teentober, the Young Adult Library Services (YALS) created a nationwide initiative celebrating teens to promote teen services and libraries, TRL sent out a notice to all our youth partnerships, organizations, and school districts

Discussion of Executive Director Highlights – **at 8:43 the recording** Trustee Mittge asks about what the Northwest Pediatric Center visits will look like mentioned in the Executive Director's report. Cheryl shares that this is still a work in progress, but it would likely include what we call an explorer Timberland box that contains books that can be taken and kept, a program started in 2014 or 2015 utilizing books removed from our collection and given away. Trustee Harrington comments on the impressive summer program attendance and wonders why in Packwood there seemed to be larger numbers of attendees. Cheryl shares that the programs in Packwood are scheduled around the Saturday market to get the best attendance numbers. Trustee Gwin comments that she and Trustee Loup are looking forward to the future report on Thunderbird Camp.

7. FINANCIAL STATEMENTS & HIGHLIGHTS – **at 15:05 of the recording** Cheryl highlights the month

ending August 31, 2025:

- **General Fund** - \$144,870.69 in property taxes were received; Timber revenue - \$84,014.06 were received; and \$298,139.56 in books and materials were purchased.
- **Unemployment Fund** – Had minimal activity.
- **Gift Fund** – Had minimal activity.
- **Building Fund** – Had minimal activity.

Discussion of Financial Highlights – at 15:44 of the recording Trustee Harrington asks about a special check request that was in the financials. Cheryl shares that it was a payroll correction for a recently reclassified employee. Paige reiterates and adds that they don't happen often, however the Board will see them periodically for a correction.

7.5. COMMITTEE REPORTS at 18:01 of the recording

1) Budget Committee – Gwin/Harrington/Vacant position

Trustee Harrington shares that the budget cycle begins in June when the library locations submit their requests for items they wish to purchase or will need in the following year. It also includes staff budgeting and any step increases; however, we are currently in contract negotiations. Paige adds that since we are in contract negotiations and we have received parameters from the Board at the last meeting in executive session, things are still being negotiated, and no COLA will be announced until those decisions have been made. All library location budget requests have been gathered and Paige is now working on a draft budget for 2026 which will be ready for review in November and approval in December. Cheryl adds that the upcoming audit for 2024 was briefly discussed and are working with the auditors for preliminary scheduling to happen in November or December.

8. FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS – None

9. BOARD HOUSEKEEPING – at 22:27 of the recording Trustee Gwin shares that Cheryl's evaluation documents will be emailed out after the Board meeting and the Executive Committee would like the Trustees to return those documents by October 1st, if possible. October 11th the Board has a work session in Tumwater. October 14th is a Facilities Committee meeting at 4:30 p.m. and the next Board meeting will be October 22nd at the Shelton Timberland Library at 5:30 p.m.

10. FINAL BOARD COMMENTS at 23:25 of the recording Trustee Gwin encourages everyone to check out Fat Bear Week on the internet and vote for your favorite fat bear.

11. ADJOURNMENT at 5:54 p.m.